The core of China's strategy revolved around how they could utilize the situation to isolate India to the greatest degree. Foremost in their thinking was their assessment that the Americans would have to be the key to uniting all the major powers in sanctioning India. China decided to make itself useful to the Americans, both in building an international coalition against India, and on interceding with Pakistan. The latter was tricky. China did not want to pressure Pakistan, or be subsequently held responsible for Pakistan's nuclear tests. The crucial element was proper coordination with the Americans. It helped that the Americans reached out to the Chinese for cooperation. The Clinton administration initially decided to turn a blind eye to the reasons adduced by India for conducting the tests. Testifying before the Congressional Subcommittee on Near Eastern and South Asian Affairs, which was chaired by Senator Sam Brownback, on 13 May 1998, Assistant Secretary of State for South Asia Karl Inderfurth peremptorily rejected the Indian rationale about the China threat. His testimony to Congress focused on India's wanton repudiation of efforts by the international community to contain the spread of nuclear weapons. [21] Three weeks later, on 3 June, on the eve of a major meeting of the Foreign Ministers of the P-5 in Geneva to discuss the nuclear situation in South Asia, and again testifying before the same subcommittee, Inderfurth made a reference to the positive role of China. He said, 'We believe that it has been playing a more constructive role in non-proliferation issues of late. China is the coordinator of the P-5 for this (Geneva) meeting, and so the Secretary (Madeleine Albright) has been working directly with her counterpart, Foreign Minister Tang (Tang Jiaxuan) to see this meeting come about in a hopefully constructive and positive way.' [22] Such statements further validated the Chinese presumption that America was the key to building the international coalition that would punish India. It